

Greyhounds Honor EP's Bill Birkhead

Special To The El Paso Times
PORTALES, N.M. — Bill Birkhead, a three-year starter at quarterback for Eastern New Mexico University, has been named ENMU's "Greatest Greyhound" for 1977.

Birkhead transferred to Eastern in 1974 from the University of Texas at El Paso and quarterbacked the Greyhounds to a 22-10-1 mark in three years.

In 1976, he completed 51 per cent of his passes for 1,156 yards and 11 touchdowns. He also punted for a 34-yards-per-boot average.

Birkhead, who was recognized for his procedure of preparing for games by playing pinball the night before a contest and coloring the tips of his white shoes green, has passed for 2,960 yards and rushed for 409 yards in his career.

A 1972 graduate of Burges High School in El Paso, he lettered at quarterback and safety while in high school and was named to the 1-A AAA All-District Team.

He is a physical education major with a minor in English.

The 6-3, 175-pound senior has 4.6 second speed in the 40-yard dash and has hopes of playing professional football.

All that's left for the University of Texas at El Paso baseball team is a slim hope that possibly one day, the Miners will pull off a major upset over either Arizona or Arizona State.

UTEP limped through the first half of the Western Athletic Conference with an 0-9 mark while Friday's foe, Arizona, leads the WAC South with a 7-2 record.

"Every year, we seem to off one upset and hopefully, we can start this weekend," said UTEP Coach Andy Cohen. "I'm optimistic about the way our team has been improving. Our boys didn't play bad ball the last series against New Mexico and if our pitching holds up, we might have a chance."

The Wildcats find themselves in almost a 'must win' situation after dropping two of three games to rival ASU last weekend which enabled the Sun Devils to pull within one game of Arizona.

The first time UTEP and Arizona met in Tucson, the Wildcats took no mercy in dealing the Miners 27-5, 10-8 and 15-5 defeats, one encouragement for UTEP is that the 18 runs the Miners scored off Arizona pitchers were the most UTEP has scored in any three-game WAC series.

Game time is noon at Dudley Field. Both teams will conclude the three-game series Saturday with a doubleheader to begin at 11 a.m.

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ALBUQUERQUE — Three El Paso basketball standouts have been



BIRKHEAD



sporting
goods

named to play on an all-star high school team against the Russian junior team here May 12.

Ralph Brewster of Bowie, Phil Spradling of Parkland and Joe Mendoza of Irvin were chosen for the U.S. team after last weekend's Cactus Invitational all-star tournament here.

All three were named to the Times' All-City team this season, with Spradling topping all city scorers with an 18.2 average. The 6-3 guard was also named to the 2-A AAA All-District team.

Mendoza, a 6-2 forward scored 14.4 points per game for the Rockets last season, while Brewster, a 6-8 center, notched 13.8 points and 14 rebounds for Bowie. Brewster made the 2-A AAA All-District team as a junior and the 1-A AAA All-District team as a senior.

Heading up the U.S. team is Texas' top high school recruit, 6-11 Gilbert Salinas of San Antonio.

CHICAGO — Knuckleball pitcher Wilbur Wood, out of action since May 9, 1976, was reactivated Thursday by the Chicago White Sox.

Wood, the Sox' No. 1 pitcher, suffered a fractured left kneecap when he was hit by a line drive in Detroit. He gradually has been working back into shape.

NEW YORK — Veteran New York sports writer Dave Eisenberg died Thursday at the age of 69.

Eisenberg was past president of the New York Basketball Writers and Golf Writers Associations and had covered those sports as well as pro football and schoolboy sports for several papers. He worked for almost 40 years for the nowdefunct New York Journal-American.

He is survived by his mother, widow, two daughters, a brother and sister and eight grandchildren. Burial will be Sunday in Brooklyn.

BIRMINGHAM, Ala. (AP) — Bonnie Lauer, the Ladies Professional Golf Association's 1976 Rookie of the Year, still is dreaming of her first tour victory on the eve of the Birmingham Classic Thursday.

"I think I can pace myself a lot better now. I'm not getting as tired. Last year I just kept playing and playing. I ended up in the hospital in August," she said.

Bonnie, who turned pro last year, won more than \$17,000 and finished second in the Girl Talk Classic, said she was confident her day in the winner's circle was coming.

"If I am playing well, then I have just as good a chance as anyone else. Experience-wise, I think I need to get in that position a little more often," she said.